way they had always been for the past eight years—Jim Kuhn was in my small compartment to talk about the arrival ceremony we would have in California; Ken Duberstein, M. B. Oglesby, and Stu Spencer were conferring in the lounge; Fred Ryan was working on the schedule; Kathy Osborne and Dottie Dellinger were at their typewriters; Dr. John Hutton was warning about the evils of smoking; Elaine Crispen, Jane Erkenbeck, and Jack Courtemanche were talking to Nancy; Jim Hooley was on the phone to the advance man at our next stop; Mark Weinberg was briefing the press photographers on what to expect at Los Angeles International Airport; Pete Souza was snapping pictures; and Bill Plante, Bob Abernathy, Gene Randall, Lou Cannon, Sam Donaldson, Dale Nelson, Lee May, Tom Ferraro, and Jerry O'Leary were in the press section predicting what I would say in my remarks when we touched down. We were joined on the flight by some staff family members: Genny and Genevieve Ryan (Genevieve was born almost a month later, which makes her the youngest passenger ever to be aboard a presidential airplane), Sydney Duberstein, Susan Wing (M. B. Oglesby's wife), Carole Kuhn, and Shelley Osborne (Kathy's daughter).

But one person was notably absent: the military aide, the person who, since twelve noon on January 20, 1981, had been at my side with the information I would need in the event of a nuclear strike. Today that officer was with the new president.

Today there would be no last-minute changes in a speech text.

There would be no conferences with the national security advisor, or air-to-ground telephone calls to cabinet members. No legislation would be signed, no press conferences would be held in the back section, no meetings with advisors in the staff section. Today I could take time to look out the windows of the airplane at the breathtaking